Day 51 (stop 1 of 2) - Old Baldy, Mac Kirk

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Beaver Valley section · hike 61 · Old Baldy

4.6 km / 2.8 mi	~1.5 h	1.9 km new	119 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

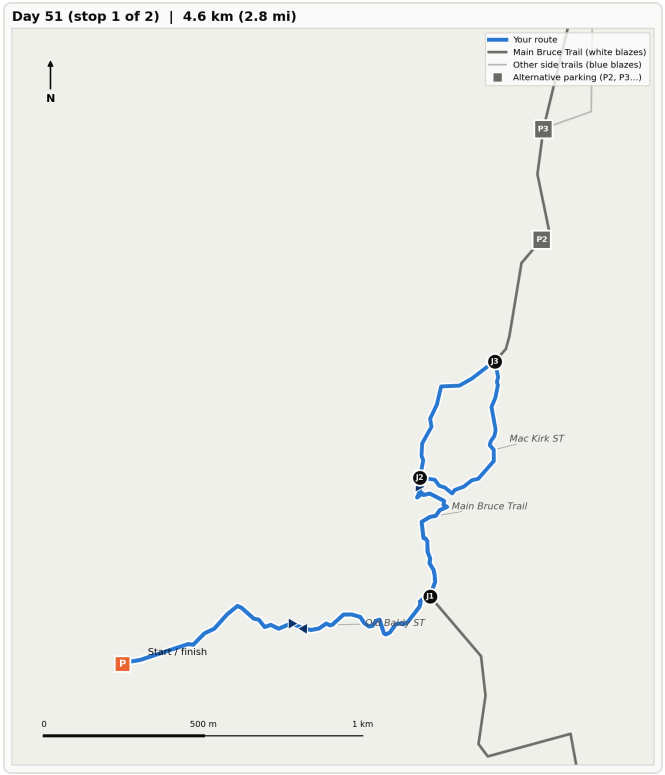
Park (P): Off road parking on east side of County Rd 13 will accommodate 3 cars. Roadside parking will accommodate more. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day51a_hike061.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Old Baldy Side Trail (1.2 km); Mac Kirk Side Trail (0.6 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 51 (5.4 mi of hiking, about 259 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 62, 2.5 mi from Accessible only from 7th Line, this parking area is found on the north side of....

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Off-road parking for about 3 cars on the east side of County Rd 13, with roadside parking for more.
- **Climb:** The Old Baldy lookout sits about 152 m above the Beaver Valley and the village of Kimberley, so expect a good climb from the valley-road parking.
- **Old Baldy lookout:** A series of rocky outlooks over the Beaver Valley and Kimberley. Footing is uneven with exposed rock and roots, and can be icy in winter.
- **Cliff edges:** The lookouts are on an unprotected edge of the Niagara Escarpment with steep drop-offs. Keep Zappy on a short leash and well back from the edge. Rock climbing is permitted here, so you may meet climbers.
- **Mac Kirk Side Trail:** Listed as covered on this outing; no published description was found.

Parking options

	Alternative parking	Parking cost	Route km	Walk to trail	Closest side trails
P2	Old Baldy Conservation Area: Pay parking for Conservation Area access map	Paid: $10 + HST per vehicle (day)	2.4	440 m	
P3	Roadside parking on the northern shoulder of Sideroad 7B where the main Trail enters the forest map	Free	2.4	800 m	

Can't do it all in one go? Split it into two shorter outings: **Outing 1** from the planned parking (P): 2.4 km / 1.5 mi, covering Old Baldy. **Outing 2** from P2 (Old Baldy Conservation Area: Pay parking for Conservation Area access; Paid: $10 + HST per vehicle (day)): 2.0 km / 1.3 mi, covering Mac Kirk. The website's map shows which parts are already done.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Off road parking on east side of County Rd 13 will accommodate 3 cars. Head east on the blue-blazed Old Baldy Side Trail.

1.2	0.7	J1: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
1.7	1.1	J2: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Mac Kirk Side Trail, heading east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
2.4	1.5	J3: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
2.8	1.8	J2: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the Mac Kirk Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
3.4	2.1	J1: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Old Baldy Side Trail, heading south-west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
4.6	2.8	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Conservation Areas and 10Adventures (Old Baldy Lookout Trail).